

The game changes phase gradually

Foundations

THE IDEA

Opening, middlegame, and endgame describe changing priorities rather than rigid move numbers. Fewer queens and heavy pieces often permit king activity. Development still matters in an early queen trade, while king safety can remain urgent in a sparse position.

WORKED EXAMPLE

After queens come off on move eight, a king may help defend central pawns, but a remaining rook can still deliver dangerous checks. Do not activate the king solely because someone called the position an endgame.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What practical sign suggests the king can become an active piece?

ANSWER AND REASONING

The opponent has limited checking power and you can identify safe central squares. Verify the route tactically before moving. Piece count is a clue, not permission.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Update your priorities as the available threats change.